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General Comment

It is vital that artificial intelligence development not be permitted to infringe on copyrighted works. As it now stands, creators of images, photographs, musical compositions, and written works are subject to their work being stolen for the purpose of training AI programs. This not only causes monetary losses to creators, it stifles creativity in the first place. AI simply cannot come up with new ideas; it simply mashes together fragments of existing work in ways that are often incoherent and, when used to generate text documents, laughably false. There is a reason such errors are called "hallucinations". Overreliance on AI has already been shown to diminish critical-thinking and other creative skills, and leads to a particular arrogance among AI users that they can solve problems by simply throwing a bunch of text and data into an AI program, and then trust what comes out of it, often without fully understanding the principles behind the problem in the first place.

Aside from the rampant theft of copyrighted material and damage to creative capabilities, AI is a potential environmental disaster. Like cryptocurrency, it consumes a vast amount of electricity while producing very little of value (although AI is not as closely associated with criminal activity). This problem will only be exacerbated by the current administration's war embrace of outdated and inefficient sources of energy.

AI has some potential, in terms of "machine learning" (the term preferred by people in the field who actually know what they're talking about, as opposed to business types interested only in hyping stock rather than solving problems). However, it has the potential for much greater harm if it is not harnessed and supervised carefully.